

To-Do App — Follow-up / Reminder Tracking

Session notes · 1 September 2026 · D:\vscode\todo · live at todo.shift-group.co

The question that started it

"When I send a reminder — e.g. today I reminded Ghassan about Bkerke — how do I register that in the To-Do app so it feeds a KPI / number of missions done per user?"

Before this session the app had no activity log at all: tasks only carried `createdBy` / `updatedBy` / `updatedAt`. The only way to record a chase was to bury it in the task name ("*bkerke, remaining to ghassan sent*"), which no metric can read.

The rule we settled on

A reminder is a touch, not a finished task. It is logged as its own event and **never** changes the task's status. Chasing 20 people must not look like finishing 20 tasks — otherwise the metric can be farmed by nudging everyone.

So the task stays the *deliverable* (rename "*bkerke, remaining to ghassan sent*" → "*Bkerke — remaining amount*"), and the chasing lives in its own history.

Telegram was explicitly excluded from this feature at Mario's request.

What was built

Logging a reminder

- Four entry points, all opening the same small form: the 🔔 in the row hover actions, the ... row menu, the **Follow-up** column cell, and a "🔔 Log a reminder" button in the task slide-over.
- The form asks **who** (autocomplete: team members + anyone chased before; pre-filled with whoever you are already waiting on), **how** (WhatsApp / Call / Email / In person / Other — last choice remembered per device), and an optional **note**. Enter submits.

Seeing it on the board

- A permanent chip after the task name: 🔔 Ghassan · 2d ago — always visible, amber once stale.
- A **Follow-up column** (sortable, column-filterable) showing last chase + who you're waiting on.
- Master search now matches on `waitingOn`, so typing a name finds everything you're waiting on from them.
- Task slide-over shows the full reminder history for that task; ✕ removes a mis-logged entry and recomputes the counters.

Dashboard — two counters, deliberately separate

- **Done this week — per person** (pre-existing): actual output.
- 🔔 **Reminders sent this week — per person**: follow-up volume.
- **Follow-through line**: "*n of N stale tasks chased in the last 14 days*" — the honest metric, since raw reminder count can be inflated.
- 🚩 **Chased but nothing moved**: reminders 3+ days old where the task hasn't budged, each with a 🔔 to chase again.

Technical record

Item	Detail
New Firestore collection	<code>events</code> — added to the refdata regex in <code>server.js</code> (GET all / POST full list, same contract as <code>folders</code> / <code>views</code>). Shape: <code>{id, taskId, taskTitle, type:'reminder', actor, target, channel, note, at}</code>
New task fields	<code>waitingOn</code> , <code>lastNudgeAt</code> , <code>nudgeCount</code> , <code>nudgeStatus</code>
Key trick	<code>nudgeStatus</code> — "chased but nothing moved" cannot use <code>updatedAt</code> , because logging the reminder is itself an update. It snapshots <code>nlStatusKey(t)</code> at reminder time; a task counts as stuck only while its status still equals that snapshot and the reminder is older than <code>NUDGE_STALE_DAYS</code> (3).
Main functions	<code>logReminder</code> , <code>nudgeStuck</code> , <code>rmOpen</code> / <code>rmSubmit</code> / <code>rmDelete</code> , <code>nlFollowCell</code> , <code>renderModalFollow</code> , <code>loadEvents</code> / <code>saveEvents</code>
Backups	<code>todo.html.bak-followup</code> , <code>server.js.bak-followup</code>

Gotcha worth remembering

The Follow-up column was **invisible** after the first deploy. Cause: `applyView` restored `state.nlColOrder` verbatim, and the starred "mario" saved view was written before the column existed, so it was dropped on every load. Fixed by extracting the back-fill the `localStorage` loader already did into a shared `nlBackfillCols(saved)`, now called from both. **Any future NL_COLS column must go through it or it will silently not appear for anyone with a saved view.**

Two smaller ones from this session: Python rewrites of `todo.html` flip CRLF → LF unless converted back (the repo is CRLF); and `io.open(p, 'w')` truncates before writing, so a failed encode empties the file — keep the `.bak` before running any rewrite script.

Testing & deployment

- All work verified on the **sandbox board** — `TEAM_ID=sandbox PORT=8083 node server.js` — driven by a headless Chromium script. Never tested against live data; sandbox left clean afterwards.
- Checked: popover opens, event saved to server, task fields stamped, column sorts and filters, modal history renders, dashboard panels correct, stale detection confirmed both ways, no console errors.
- **Deployed to Vercel production twice** (feature, then the column/chip fix): `vercel deploy --prod --yes` from `D:\vscode\todo`. Live on `todo.shift-group.co`.

Where to pick up next

- **Open:** rename the Bkerke task to the deliverable ("*Bkerke — remaining amount*") and log the reminder actually sent to Ghassan on 1 Sep.
- **Open:** the reminder chip is List-view only — Board (kanban) and Gantt cards do not show it yet.
- **Open:** reminders are task-level only; subtasks cannot be chased individually.
- **Idea:** "remind me again on <date>" (a follow-up date separate from the due date) was considered and deliberately left out to keep the first version simple.
- **Still pending from earlier sessions:** Telegram bot token, morning due-date digest via Vercel Cron, My Tasks / personal spaces, performance dashboard.